# Brian Garland

Front End Engineer · Prototyping & AI



Front end engineer with 18 years building for the web. Expert in React and TypeScript, with a focus on turning new concepts into production applications - AI tools, data visualization, and rapid prototypes. Writer, podcast host, and founder of Seattle-area tech meetups. Fluent with executives, product managers, and developers, translating between all three.

## Contact


**Email**
bri.garland@gmail.com

**AI Portfolio App**
brigarland.com

**Location**
Seattle, WA


## Tech Expertise

- **React**
- **TypeScript**
- **Next.js**
- **JavaScript**
- **HTML & CSS**
- **Fluent UI**
- **GenAI / LLM Integration**
- **Design Systems**
- **Azure**

## Employment History

### Founder & President | January 2026 - Present

Firefly in the Dark | fireflyinthedark.com

- Launched Firefly from blank canvas to production in two days - brand, style guide, and website - using an iterative AI-assisted workflow
- Maintain and extend fireflyinthedark.com in Next.js and React on Vercel, with a SQL database, a Resend newsletter pipeline, and an RSS feed that distributes the podcast to every major platform
- Produce and edit all Firefly media - long-form YouTube video, podcast audio, and short-form social clips
- Write a weekly column and long-form essays on technology, culture, and the industry; host an interview podcast with long-time practitioners
- Organize and host weekly tech networking events across the greater Seattle area, growing a local community with hundreds of members

### UX Software Engineer, Lead | September 2018 - January 2026

Blueprint Technologies

- Led front end development on enterprise AI and data visualization products for Fortune 500 clients, from first prototype to production release
- Built React, TypeScript, and Fluent UI interfaces on C# and FastAPI services backed by Databricks, Neo4j, and Azure
- Prototyped AI agent and graph-based tools for supply chain automation, then took the ones that worked to production
- Led and mentored development teams; set front end standards, ran code review, and wrote onboarding docs for new developers
- Partnered with UX designers and business stakeholders to turn research findings into shipped UI changes

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## Personal Skills

- Technical Writing
- Public Speaking & Hosting
- Rapid Prototyping
- Code Review & Mentorship
- Documentation & Onboarding
- Cross-functional Collaboration
- Community Building
- Agile (Scrum & Kanban)

## Education

**B.A. CINEMA/TELEVISION & COMPUTER ENGINEERING MINOR**
Southern Methodist University
2004 - 2008

## Honors & Awards

**EAGLE SCOUT**
2004

**ANNISTON MUSEUM OF NATURAL HISTORY VOLUNTEER OF THE YEAR**
2004

**BLUEPRINT TECHNOLOGIES CORE VALUE AWARD**
2019

### UX Engineer | January 2018 - August 2018

Microsoft (Contract through Aquent)

- Shipped features and fixes to Office UI Fabric React (now Fluent UI), an open-source TypeScript component library with 180K+ weekly downloads
- Triaged 500+ GitHub issues and brought community feedback to the product team

### Senior Web Application Developer | January 2017 - January 2018

Champagne Solutions

- Built full-stack web apps for multiple clients; led front end work and mentored a junior developer

### Lead Front-End Web Developer | July 2013 - January 2017

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- Led front end development on 200+ client websites, with primary ownership of 20
- Wrote the team's front end coding standards and onboarding process

### Web Developer / Founder | June 2012 - July 2013

Adaptive Logix

- Founded consulting company; secured The Seattle Times as first client, building SharePoint, ASP.NET, and Drupal applications for customer management

### Early Career Experience | 2008 - 2013

**The Seattle Times** - Customer Service (2012): Supported mobile app launch
**Amazon** - Digital Media Ingestion Specialist (2011): Media-On-Demand
**Lighthouse Document Technologies** - IQC (2010): Data QA for legal discovery
**Tocrok Productions** - Associate Producer (2009): Digital and interactive production projects

## References

**AVAILABLE UPON REQUEST**